

capable of optimizing the power of the new disruptive manufacturing technologies.

Having always stayed open to the new advances in technologies, Galgotias University has been providing parallel learning environments to its students for over a decade now. Galgotias University has also placed importance on faculty training & assessment to keep up to date with Industry 4.0. And for the purpose, has had tie ups with several subject matter expert trainers. And thus its students have always been ahead in terms of learning & adapting to Industry 4.0 technologies.

Overall too, the faculty development programs at Galgotias University have been on outcome based education, teaching-learning pedagogy, and new quality benchmarks to help the students with industry relevant skills.

HARNESSING EXTENDED REALITY

Though since its inception, Edtech was touted as the future of education, the pandemic hastened its acceptance as the norm. With the massive increase in traffic, Edtech platforms have been making the most of the diverse feedback to add new features. Cutting edge technologies such as virtual reality, artificial intelligence and augmented reality have been integrated. These have served to open the door of endless possibilities, creating room for immersive and integrative learning experiences. While traditional lectures primarily involve auditory & written learning styles with the addition of visuals. Immersive learning employs technology to also bring under its ambit kinetic elements. In the scientific disciplines, it provides educationally powerful dynamic visual representations to allow for real time interactions. VR can transport students to environments or periods that otherwise would not have been possible. Capable of augmenting computer generated graphics into a real environment on screen, AR can bring scientific concepts to life. It was the AR technology that was behind the extremely gripping Pokémon Go, the 2016 mobile game.

With the AR & VR technology making learning more interactive & engaging, they have been promoting sharper concentration levels among the students. By laying emphasis on exploration & practice, rather than just theories, they also contribute in boosting retention.

At the Galgotias University, the students enrolled in Computer Science, Electrical Engineering, Civil Engineering, Microbiology and other basic sciences have been using virtual labs for fully interactive simulations. In the virtual laboratories, the students get to perform experiments, collect data and answer questions to assess their understanding. A combination of animations, illustrations and videos are provided to the students to engage and enlighten them.

TAKING GIANT STRIDES INTO FUTURE

The Indian universities which focused on remodeling their curriculum in the pre-pandemic period are now receiving the dividends of having integrated academics with industry. Universities such as Galgotias, Manipal, Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham & Symbiosis have always displayed proactiveness in introducing new courses keeping the future scope in mind. Galgotias University has been offering emerging advanced technology courses such as Internet of Things (IoT), cyber security, cloud computing, artificial intelligence, robotics, augmented reality and big data analytics.

Additionally, Galgotias Centre for Technology Innovation and Incubation (GCTII) established in association with the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) provides the platform for innovative skills and business ideas to turn into a pool of start-ups.

At Galgotias University, the focus has firmly been on multidisciplinary research and education. The education dissemination model has been carefully curated to impart it with the flexibility of adapting to online, offline & hybrid learnings. It is this versatility that enabled it to face up to the challenges posed by the COVID19 pandemic and now equips it to seamlessly switch back to offline & hybrid classrooms. The university, in pursuing its aspirations to be globally celebrated for offering innovation at the intersection of disciplines, has set an example for other academic institutions in India to follow.



National Education Policy 2020 has a particularly bold vision for transforming under-graduate education to have a multi-disciplinary and liberal character.

I think that such liberal education is essential for our country. It is this kind of education which truly develops good society and good human beings. In a very real sense, such good liberal education will develop a vibrant society based on our constitutional values. In fact, that is what the NEP 2020 commits to doing.

— Azim Premji, Founder, Azim Premji University

